EMPLOYMENT

THE SKILLS MISMATCH

With one of the youngest workforces in the world, it is critical for India to ensure that the labour force is gainfully employed and equipped with future-ready skills. Today, only 4 per cent of the workforce (aged 15-59) has received vocational training, despite 88 per cent being engaged in low-competency jobs. More importantly, over 50 per cent of graduates are employed in jobs that require lower skill levels than their educational qualifications—implying underutilisation of India's workforce. These are the findings of the report 'Skills for the Future: Transforming India's Workforce Landscape' by the Institute for Competitiveness.

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS** | Text by **SONAL KHETARPAL**

WASTED TALENT#

Occupational profile of India's workforce according to skill levels



- **22.4%** Very low competency
- **65.8%** Low competency
- **2.5%** Mid competency
- **9.3%** High competency

DEGREES OF EMPLOYMENT#

Education level of India's workforce



- **52.4%** Primary/ up to 10 years of education or informal skills
- **37.8%** Secondary/ up to 11-13 years of education
- **7.6%** Graduation/ up to 14-15 years of education
- **2.2%** Postgraduation/ more than 15 years of education

JOB PROFILES AS PER SKILL LEVELS*

Very low competency skills (*up to primary level or up to 10 years of education/ informal skills*): Elementary occupations

Low competency skills (*up to secondary level or up to 13 years of education*): Clerks, service, and shop and market sales workers, skilled agricultural and fishery workers, craft and related trades workers, plant and machine operators and assemblers

Mid competency skills (*up to graduation or 14-15 years of education*): Associate professionals

High competency skills (*postgraduation or more than 15 years of education*): Professionals

**As per Ministry of Labour & Employment's National Classification of Occupations code*

#Data for 2023-24

The report analysed Periodic Labour Force Survey data for the workforce aged 15 to 59 years from 2017-18 to 2023-24